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The Key to Understanding the Quran (RICC Khutbah)

إن الحمد لله نحمده ونستعينه ونستغفره، ونعوذ بالله تعالى من شرور أنفسنا، وسيئات أعمالنا، من يهده الله تعالى فلا مضل له، ومن يضلل فلا هادي له، وأشهد أن لا إله إلا الله وحده لا شريك له، وأشهد أن محمداً عبده ورسوله، اللهم صلّ وسلم وبارك على سيدنا محمد وعلى آله وأصحابه ومن تبعه إلى يوم الدين

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا اتَّقُوا اللَّهَ حَقَّ تَقَاتِهِ وَلَا تَمُوتُنَّ إِلَّا وَأَنتُمْ مُسْلِمُونَ [آل عمران:102]. أما بعد:
فإن أصدق الحديث كلام الله تعالى، وخير الهدي هدي محمد صلى الله عليه وسلم، وشر الأمور محدثاتها، وكل محدثة بدعة، وكل بدعة ضلالة، وكل ضلالة في النار.

Every field of knowledge has its principles and methodology. Mathematics cannot be understood without its rules. Medicine cannot be practiced without its foundations. Law cannot be applied without its methodology. The Qur'an is no different.

Proper understanding of the Qur'an requires more than recitation. It requires an approach that recognizes its unique nature and follows the method by which it is meant to be understood.

Many misunderstandings of the Qur'an do not arise from the text itself, but from how it is approached.

Verses may be taken out of context, separated from related passages, or interpreted based on modern usage rather than Qur'anic terminology. Sometimes conclusions are drawn from part of the Qur'an while neglecting the whole.

For this reason, several foundational questions must be addressed:

- What is the nature of the Qur'an?
- What proves that it is divine revelation?
- Why did Allah guarantee its preservation?
- Why was it revealed in Arabic?
- What is the correct methodology for understanding it?

In this khutbah, and in future ones, we will, inshallah, address these questions, as they are essential for building a sound relationship with the Qur'an.

Today, we begin with the nature of the Qur'an.

The Qur'an is the revealed Word of Allah, sent to the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ as guidance for all humanity until the end of time. It is the final revelation through which Allah perfected His religion and established the ultimate authority in matters of faith, worship, morality, and human life.

It is a universal message addressed to all people in every age, calling them to know their Creator, purify themselves, and fulfill their role on earth according to His guidance.

Allah says:

﴿هَذَا بَيَانٌ لِلنَّاسِ وَهُدًى وَمَوْعِظَةٌ لِّلْمُتَّقِينَ﴾ (آل عمران: 138)

"This is a clear declaration for mankind, and a guidance and an admonition for those who are mindful of Allah." (*Al-'Imran 3:138*)

He also says:

﴿تَبَارَكَ الَّذِي نَزَّلَ الْفُرْقَانَ عَلَى عَبْدِهِ لِيَكُونَ لِلْعَالَمِينَ نَذِيرًا﴾ (الفرقان: 1)

"Blessed is He who sent down the Criterion upon His servant so that he may be a warner to all the worlds." (*Al-Furqan 25:1*)

The Qur'an is unlike any human book. Human works are limited to specific subjects, history, law, science, or literature. The Qur'an does not fit into any single category because it is divine revelation.

It is a book of guidance, but also a book of faith, law, morality, education, and reflection. It speaks to the intellect with evidence, to the heart with spiritual guidance, and to human nature in a way that aligns with its innate disposition. **Its goal is not only to inform, but to transform.**

For this reason, it must not be approached like an ordinary book.

One of the keys to understanding the Qur'an is recognizing its educational methodology.

There are generally two methods of teaching:

- The linear method, where knowledge builds step by step
- The spiral method, where themes are revisited repeatedly with increasing depth

The Qur'an follows the second method.

Its central themes, such as the Oneness of Allah, prophethood, the Hereafter, morality, and justice, appear throughout the Qur'an in different contexts. Each time, they add new meaning, depth, and application, gradually building a complete understanding.

To achieve this, the Qur'an uses diverse methods:

- Stories and historical accounts
- Parables
- Dialogue
- Questions that provoke reflection
- Calls to observe and contemplate creation

In this way, the Qur'an actively engages both the mind and the heart, guiding the reader toward conviction through reflection.

From the earliest times, people have asked: Is the Qur'an truly from Allah, or is it the work of a human being?

In the modern world, we are taught that any serious claim must be testable. In the philosophy of science, this is known as falsifiability, the idea that a claim should be open to being proven false.

A well-known example is Albert Einstein's theory of general relativity. When he proposed it, he did not ask people to accept it blindly. Instead, he identified a clear test: if light from distant stars were observed bending around the sun during a solar eclipse, his theory would be supported; if not, it would be disproven. When the observation was made, it matched his prediction, and the theory gained acceptance.

The Qur'an presents its message in a similar spirit, but in a far greater and more profound way. It calls people not to blind belief, but to reflection, examination, and verification.

It sets clear criteria:

- If it were from other than Allah, it would contain contradictions.
- If it were human speech, others would be able to produce something like it.

﴿أَفَلَا يَتَذَكَّرُونَ الْقُرْآنَ ۚ وَلَوْ كَانَ مِنْ عِنْدِ غَيْرِ اللَّهِ لَوَجَدُوا فِيهِ اخْتِلَافًا كَثِيرًا﴾ (النساء: 82).

"Will they not then reflect upon the Qur'an? Had it been from anyone other than Allah, they would surely have found within it many inconsistencies." (Al-Nisa' 4:82)

He also says:

﴿وَإِنْ كُنْتُمْ فِي رَيْبٍ مِمَّا نَزَّلْنَا عَلَىٰ عَبْدِنَا فَأْتُوا بِسُورَةٍ مِثْلِهِ ... فَإِنْ لَمْ تَفْعَلُوا وَلَنْ تَفْعَلُوا فَاتَّقُوا النَّارَ...﴾ (البقرة: 23-24).

"And if you are in doubt concerning what We have sent down upon Our servant, then produce a single Surah like it... But if you do not—and you will never do so—then fear the Fire..." (Al-Baqarah 2:23-24)

And He says:

﴿قُلْ لِّئِنْ اجْتَمَعَتِ الْإِنْسُ وَالْجِنُّ عَلَىٰ أَنْ يَأْتُوا بِمِثْلِ هَذَا الْقُرْآنِ لَا يَأْتُونَ بِمِثْلِهِ وَلَوْ كَانَ بَعْضُهُمْ لِبَعْضٍ ظَهِيرًا﴾ (الإسراء: 88).

"Say: If all mankind and the jinn were to gather together to produce the like of this Qur'an, they could never produce its like, even if they assisted one another." (Al-Isra' 17:88)

These are open challenges, addressed to all people, in every age. Yet, they remain unmet for more than fourteen centuries.

أقول قولي هذا وأستغفر الله العظيم لي ولكم فاستغفروه إنه هو الغفور الرحيم

الحمد لله، وأشهد أن لا إله إلا الله وحده لا شريك له، وأشهد أن محمدًا عبده ورسوله، صلى الله عليه وعلى آله وصحبه وسلم تسليماً كثيراً. أما بعد، عباد الله، أوصيكم ونفسي بتقوى الله.

The open challenges of the Quran to invalidate its divine origin have remained unmet for more than fourteen centuries.

At the same time, the Qur'an declares the breadth of its guidance. Allah says:

﴿وَنَزَّلْنَا عَلَيْكَ الْكِتَابَ تِبْيَانًا لِّكُلِّ شَيْءٍ وَهُدًى وَرَحْمَةً وَبُشْرَىٰ لِلْمُسْلِمِينَ﴾

“And We have sent down to you the Book as a clarification for all things, and as guidance, mercy, and glad tidings for those who submit.” (Al-Nahl 16:89)

This means that the Qur'an provides complete guidance for what every human being needs to know to fulfill his purpose: belief, worship, morality, and the principles by which life is lived and establish righteous civilization.

So, the Qur'an invites you, especially you, our youth, not to accept blindly, but to think, reflect, and examine. And this is the path to certainty.

اللهم صلّ وسلم وبارك على سيدنا محمد وعلى آله وأصحابه

اللهم اهدنا فيمن هديت ، وعافنا فيمن عافيت ، وتولنا فيمن توليت ، وبارك لنا فيما أعطيت ، وقنا واصرف عنا شر ما قضيت اللهم أدخلنا برحمتك في عبادك الصالحين ، أخرجنا من ظلمات الجهل والوهم إلى أنوار العلم اللهم اجعلنا ممن يستمعون القول فيتبعون أحسنه اللهم اجعلنا من الصائمين القائمين، اللهم بفضلك ورحمتك أعل كلمة الحق والدين ، وانصر الإسلام ، وأعز المسلمين يا أكرم الأكرمين .

O Allah, spread your mercy upon us, shower us with Your blessings, increase our knowledge, grant us forgiveness, and reward us by the company of Your prophets in the highest place in Heaven, Al-Ferdous Al-Aala.

O Allah, forgive our parents and all our friends and relatives who have passed away and make their graves a garden from heaven and grant them the Ferdous Al-Ala.

O Allah, we have many of our friends and relatives who are sick. O Allah grant them full and speedy recovery.

O Allah, guide our children, protect them and make them righteous.

O Allah we have many of our brethren, who are subjected to injustice and oppression, O Allah, heal their trauma, protect the helpless, fulfill their needs, and grant them lasting peace and prosperity

O Allah, we ask you in this blessed hour with every name you have elected for yourself that none of us leave this gathering, **except** his pains have been relieved, his worries have been removed, his debts have been paid, his weaknesses have been concealed, his sins have been forgiven, and his needs have been fulfilled,

إِنَّ اللَّهَ وَمَلَائِكَتَهُ يُصَلُّونَ عَلَى النَّبِيِّ يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا صَلُّوا عَلَيْهِ وَسَلِّمُوا تَسْلِيمًا (الأحزاب (33:56)

اللهم صلّ وسلم وبارك على سيدنا محمد وعلى آله وأصحابه

وَأَقِمِ الصَّلَاةَ إِنَّ الصَّلَاةَ تَنْهَى عَنِ الْفَحْشَاءِ وَالْمُنْكَرِ